

Learning

Unit 10 of 12 · Grammar Study Sheet

Talk about subjects, experiences, memory, and habits using the present perfect and past simple.

What you will be able to do

- ✓ Use the present perfect correctly
- ✓ Ask about past experiences
- ✓ Talk about subjects
- ✓ Talk about learning
- ✓ Check and clarify information

4 lessons in this unit

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Topics: subjects · learning verbs · synonyms & antonyms · present perfect

Vocabulary — School subjects

history	physics	literature	geography
biology	mathematics	chemistry	IT (information technology)

Each subject studies a different topic: history → the past · physics → heat, light, energy · literature → books · geography → places · biology → living things · mathematics → numbers · chemistry → chemicals · IT → computers.

Vocabulary — Learning verbs

learn	study	pass	fail
forget	remember	know	understand
teach	discover	invent	design
practise			

Synonyms — words with similar meanings: learn = study. Antonyms — words with opposite meanings: pass ≠ fail.

Present perfect

Use the present perfect to talk about something that happened in the past but is connected to NOW (we don't say exactly when).

+	Subject + have/has + past participle
–	Subject + haven't/hasn't + past participle
?	Have/Has + subject + past participle?

Examples:

- I've learned the vocabulary for the test.
- He's invented a new robot.
- We've discovered a new type of medicine.
- I haven't done my homework. He hasn't passed the exam.
- Have you forgotten his phone number? — Yes, I have. / No, I haven't.
- Note: Regular verbs add -ed (learn → learned). Irregular verbs have their own forms (do → done, go → been/gone).

Have you ever ...?

Use "Have you ever ...?" to ask about past experiences. Use "never" in negative answers.

Examples:

- Have you ever studied French? — No, I've never studied French.
- Have you ever failed a test? — Yes, I have. I've failed my driving test twice!
- Have you ever met a famous person?

Lesson 10b · How good is your memory?

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Topics: memory · present perfect vs past simple · -ed endings

Vocabulary — Things to remember

names and faces	directions	addresses	telephone numbers
dates	facts	shopping lists	songs

Pronunciation — Past tense -ed endings

The "-ed" ending of regular past tense verbs has THREE different sounds depending on the last sound of the base verb.

- /t/ — after voiceless sounds (k, p, s, ʃ, tʃ, f): washed, watched, stopped, helped
- /d/ — after voiced sounds (b, g, l, m, n, v, vowels): loved, played, called, opened
- /ɪd/ — after t or d sounds (extra syllable): wanted, started, decided, needed

Present perfect vs Past simple

Both tenses talk about the past. The choice depends on whether we say WHEN it happened.

Past simple	when we KNOW or SAY the exact time
Present perfect	when we DON'T say or know the exact time

Examples:

- Nelson HAS WON the USA Memory Championship four times. (general — no exact time)
- He WON the competition in 2011, 2012, 2014 and again in 2015. (exact times)
- My friend HAS PASSED his maths exam twice. He FAILED it last year and this year.
- Have you ever studied in another country? — Yes, I've studied in Mexico. (experience)
- When did you study there? — I studied in Mexico in 1993. (specific time)

Topics: daily habits · word focus: up

Vocabulary — Daily habits

drinking coffee	brushing teeth	swimming	biting fingernails
eating chocolate	checking phone	smoking	practising guitar
putting sugar in tea	eating breakfast	learning new words	

Word focus: up

Many phrasal verbs combine a verb with "up". Each combination has its own meaning.

Examples:

- get up = get out of bed (He gets up at 6.30 a.m.)
- wake up = stop sleeping (We wake up at seven every day.)
- give up = stop doing a bad habit (They want to give up smoking.)
- go up = increase (The cost of food goes up in the winter.)
- dress up = wear fun or nice clothes (I always dress up for a party.)

Lesson 10d · Communication problems + voicemail + memory video

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Topics: checking & clarifying · contrastive stress · email & websites · imperatives · memory · video lesson

Vocabulary — Email addresses & websites (10e)

@ = at	. = dot	_ = underscore	/ = slash
- = hyphen			

Example: j_jones@hotmail.co.uk → "j underscore jones at hotmail dot co dot uk"

Vocabulary — Language learning (10f)

alphabet	classroom	pronunciation	memorize
repeat	translate	vocabulary	practice
fluent			

Pronunciation — Contrastive stress (10d)

When you correct information, put strong stress on the corrected word — that signals the change to the listener.

- A: Is that three in the MORNING? — B: No, in the AFTERNOON.
- A: Was that the ENCASA Hotel? — B: No, the ANCASA Hotel. A for apple.
- A: Is that E for England? — B: No, it's A for apple.

Real life — Checking and clarifying (10d)

When you can't hear or understand on the phone, use these phrases to check the information.

Examples:

- Is that three in the morning? — No, in the afternoon.
- Was that the Encasa Hotel? — No, the Ancasa Hotel. A for apple.
- The number is 603 2169 2266. — So that's 603 2169 2266.
- Have you called our colleagues? — Yes, I have.
- Have you emailed me all the designs? — No, I haven't.

Writing skill — Imperatives in messages (10e)

When you write a phone message, simplify what the speaker said by using the IMPERATIVE form (= just the base verb, no subject).

Examples:

- Speaker: "He can download them from this address: omarox.com/a-1"
- Message: "Download them from omarox.com/a-1."
- Speaker: "Can you call Jim back this evening?"
- Message: "Call Jim back this evening."